Has done

ha means “has”. Put he, has, ha, hemos or han in front of the verb’s -ado / -ido form and you have “have done”: ha tenido, has had.

ONLY THE HELPER CHANGES

	hablar speak	**comer** eat	**vivir** live
yo	**he** hablado	**he** comido	**he** vivido
tú	**has** hablado	**has** comido	**has** vivido
él, ella, usted	**ha** hablado	**ha** comido	**ha** vivido
nosotros	**hemos** hablado	**hemos** comido	**hemos** vivido
ellos, ustedes	**han** hablado	**han** comido	**han** vivido

READ IT WORD BY WORD

Le **ha costado** más.

It’s been harder for her. Word by word: to her, it has cost more.

Ha tenido que trabajar mucho.

She has had to work a lot.

Not ha tenía or ha tiene. After ha comes only the -ado / -ido form: ha tenido. Without ha, tenía que trabajar (she had to work) is right on its own.

THE IRREGULAR ONES: LEARN THEM WHOLE

	after ha	English
hacer	ha **hecho**	has done, made
decir	ha **dicho**	has said
ver	ha **visto**	has seen
poner	ha **puesto**	has put
escribir	ha **escrito**	has written
volver	ha **vuelto**	has come back
abrir, romper, morir	ha **abierto**, **roto**, **muerto**	has opened, broken, died

WHEN TO USE IT: UP TO NOW

¿Ya **has comido**?

Have you eaten yet?

Nunca **he ido** a Japón.

I’ve never been to Japan.

In Mexico: for something that just happened, people often use the plain past where Spain uses this one: ¿Ya comiste? more than ¿Ya has comido? Both are right. You’ll still hear he, has, ha every day, above all with alguna vez, nunca and todavía no.

SOURCES

- RAE–ASALE, Nueva gramática básica de la lengua española (2011): the present perfect (pretérito perfecto compuesto), haber with the participle, the irregular participles, and how much of the Americas, Mexico included, uses the simple past for recent events.
- Every form is checked against Lector’s verb tables (Wiktionary via kaikki.org, CC BY-SA 4.0).